

BIG BATTLE OVER BIG TECH

TOP EXECUTIVES of leading technology start-ups including Flipkart, Paytm, Zomato, Swiggy, OYO, Ola and MakeMyTrip met a group of parliamentarians to discuss anti-competitive practices by the Big Tech firms. The domestic e-commerce leaders brought a slew of issues to the notice of the parliamentarians, including predatory pricing and the lack of a level-playing field. The Big Tech companies such as Amazon, Google, Meta and Twitter are expected to meet the committee to present their side of the story soon.

—BINU PAUL

Monkeypox Alert

India has so far recorded at least four cases of the viral Monkeypox disease. Currently, smallpox vaccines and some antiviral drugs such as Tecovirimat are used in its treatment. The Indian pharma industry is considering developing new drugs, vaccines and diagnostics to counter Monkeypox. There are no manufacturers of the smallpox vaccine in India as the country has eradicated the disease, but Serum Institute of India is planning to develop an mRNA vaccine with its global partner Novovax.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA



DOWN BUT NOT OUT

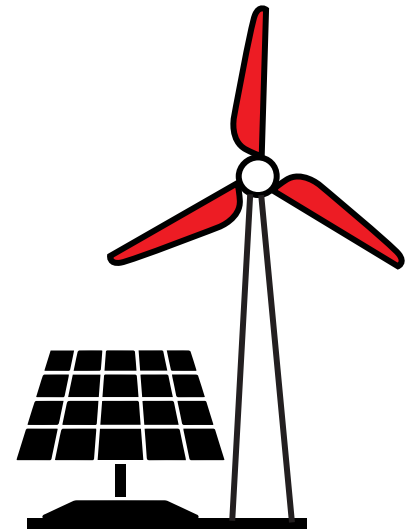
Amid high inflationary pressure and tightening of monetary policy across the world, the IMF has slashed India's GDP growth outlook for FY23 to 7.4 per cent, which is a downward revision of 0.8 per cent. Despite the downward revision, the growth estimate by IMF is slightly higher than RBI's latest estimate of 7.2 per cent. Despite the downward revision, India is projected to grow faster than developed economies like the US and China.

—RAJAT MISHRA

TURBULENT WEATHER

Following repeated instances of "degraded safety margins", aviation regulator DGCA has curtailed the number of flights operated by SpiceJet by 50 per cent for the next two months. DGCA has also said it will maintain "enhanced surveillance" on the airline for the next eight weeks. Meanwhile, the airline claimed the order won't impact operations as it had already rescheduled flights owing to lean demand.

—MANISH PANT



RENEW THE OBLIGATION

Under revised targets set by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), power distribution companies need to source 24.61 per cent of the energy supplied in their areas from renewable energy sources in FY23. By the decade's end, they are expected to procure 43.33 per cent of their total consumption from renewable energy and another 4 per cent through energy storage obligations, say official estimates. However, meeting the targets won't be easy.

—MANISH PANT

**\$70
BILLION**

FALL IN FOREX RESERVES SINCE SEPTEMBER 3, 2021. THE FIGURE PLUNGED BY NEARLY 11 PER CENT TO \$572.71 BILLION ON JULY 15, 2022 FROM \$642.45 BILLION ON SEPTEMBER 3 LAST YEAR, ACCORDING TO THE RBI